



4 Take the pan off the heat to test for a set. Put one teaspoon of jam on one of the cold saucers. Leave it to cool, then push it to one side with your finger. If it wrinkles and your finger leaves a trail, it is set.



5 Ladle the jam into warm sterilized jars using a sterilized jam funnel. Fill the jars almost to the brim. Cover the hot jam with waxed paper discs and seal with metal lids, or cellophane covers and elastic bands. If there is scum on the surface of the jam, use a skimmer to remove it before you pot up, or stir the jam in the same direction until the scum has dispersed.

VARIATION



Plum and port jam

Makes 6 medium jars

Put 1.8kg (4lb) dark plums, a cinnamon stick, and the juice of one lime in a preserving pan or a large, heavy-bottomed saucepan and add 600ml (1 pint) of water. Bring the fruit mix to a simmering point. Turn the heat down to low just as it starts to bubble, then simmer for 15–20 minutes or until the plums begin to break down and soften. Add 1.35kg (3lb) granulated sugar, stirring with a wooden spoon until completely dissolved. Turn the heat up high, bring to the boil, and keep at a rolling boil for 5–8 minutes or until the mixture thickens and the bubbles become large and start “popping”. Test for a set using the wrinkle test (see Step 4). If the jam hasn’t set, bring it back to a rolling boil for another minute and test again. When the jam has set, carefully remove the cinnamon stick, stir in 2–3 tablespoons of port, then ladle the jam into warm sterilized jars. Cover with waxed paper discs, seal and leave to cool.